



YASTEEL SEWNARAIN

Backend Developer

About me

Backend developer with a tactical, iterative learning style and a strong foundation in Java, Spring Boot, SQL and Golang. Former educator and finance professional turned engineer, driven by curiosity, clarity, and real-world problem-solving. Experienced in building and debugging backend APIs, designing robust DTOs, and aligning models for maintainability. Passionate about clean architecture, semantic clarity, and sustainable growth in tech.



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Gauteng, South Africa

Technical Skills

Languages & Frameworks:

- Java & Spring Boot – Used extensively in Booking App and Petstore backend projects for RESTful API development
- Go (Golang) – Exploring backend architecture and clean CRUD scaffolding with idiomatic Go practices
- JavaScript – Built interactive browser-based RPG with modular turn-based logic
- HTML & CSS – Applied in frontend scaffolding and layout testing for personal projects

Backend & API Development:

- RESTful API design and testing with Postman
- DTO structuring for safe partial updates and model alignment
- SQL & PostgreSQL – Schema design, querying, and integration with SQLBoiler for model-driven development
- Git version control and tactical debugging

Tools & Practices:

- Test-driven development (TDD) and modular architecture
- Tactical logging for traceability in production-like environments
- Documentation and README authoring for portfolio clarity

Portfolio with projects: [🌐 yasteel7.github.io](https://yasteel7.github.io)

GitHub: github.com/yasteel7

Education

PGCE (FET Phase – Accounting), Mancosa
BAccSci, University of the Witwatersrand
Full Stack Dev Certification, FNB App Academy

Language

- English (Native)
- Afrikaans (intermediate)
- Japanese (basic)
- Hindi (basic)

Expertise

- API Design
- DTO Structuring
- UUID Handling
- SQL Queries
- Go & Java
- Spring Boot
- Postman Testing
- Schema Design
- Debugging
- Logging
- Git Workflow
- Modular CRUD
- Partial Updates
- Model Alignment
- Clean Architecture
- Visual Hierarchy
- Tactical Learning

Achievements

- Dux student
- 90% Matric average
- Prefect
- Public Speaking award (first place from 150)
- Multiple awards for highest mark in various subjects
- Represented Gauteng in chess.

References

Available upon request

Experience

Open Minds Campus

Facilitator

Jan 2022 – Dec 2024

- Taught IT, Robotics, Coding, and core subjects across Grades 6–9.
- Introduced students to programming fundamentals and logical thinking.
- Organized chess tournaments and musical performances.
- Applied Montessori and British Curriculum methodologies

Sanlam

Financial Advisor

Jun 2021 – Jan 2022

- Provided tailored financial advice focused on retirement, investment, and risk planning.
- Conducted comparative analysis across competitor offerings.
- Facilitated financial reviews and long-term planning strategies.

Ransome Russouw Chartered Accountants

Auditor

Dec 2020 – Mar 2021

- Prepared audit work papers and reviewed financial statements.
- Participated in two full-cycle audits for small enterprises.
- Applied Excel-based analysis to support compliance and reporting.

WesBank

Contact Centre Agent

Mar 2020 – Dec 2020

- Resolved daily queries related to vehicle finance and interest rates.
- Delivered high-quality customer service and issue tracking.
- Identified recurring problems to improve operational efficiency.

Private

Tutor

2014 – 2020

- Tutored Grades 10–12 in Mathematics, Physical Sciences, and Accounting
- Developed personalized learning plans and supported academic performance